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An analysis of citizen satisfaction with public service delivery in the Sedibeng district municipality of South Africa

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Abstract

Purpose – The purpose of this paper is to analyze citizen satisfaction with public service delivery in the Sedibeng district municipality of South Africa. The municipality consists of three local municipalities, Lesedi, Emfuleni and Midvaal.

Design/methodology/approach – The sampling procedure was carefully designed, taking into account the spatial distribution of the population in the Sedibeng district municipality and the three local municipalities. A structured sample of 1,000 respondents was used for the study and descriptive and inferential statistics approaches were used. The focus was on citizen satisfaction with public service delivery in health care, housing, water, electricity, solid waste removal, community services or overall physical appearance of the community, cutting crimes and job creation.

Findings – Respondents are most dissatisfied with roads maintenance, government efforts to create jobs and reduce crime. Respondents from Emfuleni local municipality hold more positive feelings about public service delivery in the area of water, electricity, and solid waste. Their most negative feeling is in the area of job creation, roads and the municipality's efforts in cutting down on crime. On balance, respondents from Lesedi hold positive feelings about public service delivery only in the area of water and electricity supplies. Similarly, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime. Respondents from Midvaal do not hold positive feelings about public service delivery in their local municipality. Similar to other two local municipalities, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime. Overall, the most negative sentiment about public service delivery has been expressed by respondents from Midvaal, followed by Emfuleni and Lesedi.

Practical implications – It is important for public service delivery in Sedibeng municipality to improve so that citizens' public confidence can rise.

Originality/value – Throughout Africa, governments have been entrusted to finance and provide basic services such as health, education, telecommunications, safe water and modern sanitation. Adequate access to these services enhances development. Public services are a key determinant of quality of life that is not measured in per capita income. They are also an important element of any poverty reduction strategy. Thus, improving public service delivery is one of the biggest challenges in the continent.

Keywords South Africa, Public sector, Public services, Public policy, Public evaluation, Public service delivery, Citizen satisfaction, Municipalities

Paper type Research paper

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1. Introduction

The municipalities are the basic units of government in South Africa. They provide basic services to the community. Their employees communicate daily with residential and business customers about issues of trash pickup, police and fire emergencies, road construction, environmental services, urban planning and regulatory enforcement, local public works and housing utility service and billing inquiries, fire fighting, etc. It is important to know how satisfied citizens are, with how they deliver these services and how these officials respond to service enquiries.

The traditional belief is that customer service is not its highest priority of government. Public services usually have a built-in customer base. This monopoly does not prompt governments to improve their services. In South Africa, times are changing. There have been a lot of service delivery protests in South Africa recently stemming from dissatisfaction with public service delivery in general. The following were identified as the main reasons that have been cited for the service delivery protests in South Africa in 2010 including:

- lack of/poor service delivery (water, sanitation, electricity, refuse removal);
- lack of/inadequate housing;
- evictions;
- high levels of unemployment;
- lack of communication with communities;
- lack of leadership in the municipality;
- corruption;
- nepotism;
- maladministration; and
- financial mismanagement.

As a result, many municipal governments in South Africa have started to become more involved in customer satisfaction surveys in order to improve their service delivery.

Citizen satisfaction surveys are an established method for US local governments and public administration researchers to assess the quality of local government services. Local governments in South Africa are following international trends to regularly survey their citizens in an effort to assess their needs and gauge their satisfaction with the quality of local government services. Authors suggest that this trend is a reflection of a renewed emphasis on performance measurement and an interest in making local governments more customer-focused and responsive to their citizens (Bouckaert *et al.*, 2002; Kettl, 2000). Citizens feedback becomes an effective means for improving the performance of public services as it can be used to demand accountability from providers, especially when there are no alternatives due to regulation in the delivery of services.

There are not very many citizen satisfaction studies conducted in African countries. Therefore, this study seeks to examine citizen's satisfaction with public service delivery in Sedibeng District Municipality of South Africa.

1.1 The reasons why citizen satisfaction surveys merit study

It is important to conduct citizen satisfaction surveys for a number of reasons. Amin *et al.* provide detailed explanations of the importance of conducting

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satisfaction studies. It is suggested that satisfaction surveys have considerable appeal as a practical way of measuring the impact of governance.

Such surveys can be a quick and easy way for policymakers to measure the impact of governance reforms on government performance, particularly for sectors where measurement of service quality is not easy, provided citizen satisfaction is closely correlated with the actual quality of services. In addition, understanding what factors influence citizen satisfaction is crucial in order to evaluate the impact of decentralization or other governance reform exercises.

One important contribution of this paper is that it allows us to move significantly towards a more informed understanding of the multi-dimensional concept of citizen's satisfaction to public service delivery in South Africa where little empirical or comparative data has been published.

Second, it contributes to the objective of achieving a more user-focused healthcare service. In order to improve public service provision, managers need to be able to differentiate between factors they have control over and those that are part of a wider social and political context. Citizen satisfaction studies inform planning as part of a range of assessment indicators used to compare different alternatives of organizing and providing public services. Third, it contributes the policy agenda of developed countries where the user's perspective is certainly, entering as a vital component of public service delivery system.

1.2 Demarcation of the study area

The Sedibeng District Municipality includes Emfuleni, Lesedi, and Midvaal local municipalities (LMs). The percentage contribution of LMs to the total gross value added (GVA) of Sedibeng by economic activity are shown as percentages, the value that each LM has contributed to the Sedibeng District's economy during 1996, 2001, and 2007. Emfuleni LM made the largest contribution (82.7 percent in 1996, 80.2 percent in 2001, and 79.1 percent in 2007) to the total GVA of Sedibeng District. The Midvaal LM was the second largest contributor to the total GVA, contributing 11.3 percent in 1996, 12.6 percent in 2001, and 13.5 percent in 2007. The Lesedi LM made the least contribution to Sedibeng's total GVA.

The manufacturing sector is the largest contributor to the economy of Sedibeng. In 1996, 2001, and 2007 the three sectors contributed 51.6, 43.6, and 44.3 percent, respectively, and together they contribute 48.6 percent of a total Sedibeng economy representing an increase of 2.6 percent.

The tertiary sector is basically the services sector as well as the government and contributes 49.7 percent to the Sedibeng GVA. Community (or government) services sector was the second largest contributor to the economy of Sedibeng as it contributed 17.2 percent in 1996, 22.5 percent in 2001, and 19.4 percent in 2007. This sector has been declining by 1.3 percent.

The Sedibeng District Municipality, which is part of Gauteng province, reflects the challenges that have been identified nationally. These include:

- a high unemployment rate (24 percent);
- a shortage of skilled labour; and
- a high HIV/AIDS incidence (16 percent).

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2. What are services?

Services are usually defined as "deeds, processes, and performances" (Zeithaml and Bitner, 2000, p. 2). The concept of service comes from business literature. Many scholars have offered various definitions of service. Ramaswamy (1996, p. 3) described service as "business transactions that take place between a donor (service provider) and receiver (customer) in order to produce an outcome that satisfies the customer." Zeithaml and Bitner (1996) defined service as "deeds, processes, and performances."

Yong (2000) reviewed various definitions of service and noted the following features of service that are important to an understanding of the concept. First, service is a performance. It happens through interaction between consumers and service providers (Deighton, 1992; Gronroos, 1990; Ramaswamy, 1996; Sasser *et al.*, 1978; Zeithaml and Bitner, 1996). Second, factors such as physical resources and environments play an important mediating role in the process of service production and consumption (Collier, 1994; Gronroos, 1990). Third, service is a requirement in terms of providing certain functions to consumers, for example problem solving (Gronroos, 1990; Ramaswamy, 1996).

2.1 Characteristics of services

Some authors believe that services are intangible. This implies that they cannot be seen, touched, held, or stored (Zeithaml *et al.*, 1990). However, Zeithaml *et al.* (1990) believes that services are not all intangible, but, rather, are placed on a continuum of intangibility. Even if it can be said in extreme terms that pure services are intangible and pure goods are tangible, most services and goods exist between the two extremes of the intangibility continuum, having both tangible and intangible elements. For example, the delivery of medical services involves consultation and the prescription of medicines. They also believe that services are heterogeneous. Their performance often varies from producer to producer, from customer to customer, and from day to day. This is essentially because service production and delivery often involves the interaction of both service personnel and customers.

According to Lovelock (1981), there are two dimensions and four sub-classifications of services depending on who or what the direct recipient of the service is, whether it is "people" or "things"; and what the nature of the service act is, whether it is "tangible" or "intangible" (Table I).

2.2 Nature of public service

The nature of public services is discussed in Jones and Gessaman (1974). Services are provided in the public sector when they cannot be done adequately in the private sector (Atkinson and Stiglitz, 1980, pp. 5-6). The market is not an effective mechanism for indicating needs for or allocating public products or service. Thus, in the absence of effective market mechanisms, various levels of government carry out supply and market intervention activities designed to ensure the availability of community services when and where a need has been expressed. Local governments have been the principal providers, but have been hampered by a limited ability to bear the associated costs, especially where population density is low and service delivery is costly or difficult.

The characteristics of public services are the following:

- The services are thought necessary for the public good.
- They are available to and utilized by the general public.

		Who or what is the direct recipient of the service	
		People	Things
What is the nature of the service act		*Services directed at people's bodies*	*Services directed at goods and other physical possession*
	Tangible action	Health care	Freight transportation
		Passenger transportation	Industrial equipment repair and maintenance
		Exercises clinics	Janitorial services
		Restaurants	Laundry and dry cleaning
		Haircutting	Landscaping/lawn care
		Freight transportation	Veterinary care
	Intangible actions	*Services directed at people's minds*	*Services directed at intangible assets*
		Education	Banking
		Broadcasting	Legal services
		Information services	Accounting
		Theatres	Securities
		Museums	Insurance

Table I.
Dimension of services

Source: Adapted from Lovelock (1981, p. 12)

- They are generally provided through relatively rigid institutional arrangements by the public sector or regulated private monopolies with high fixed investment.
- Prices of services (fees) are not set in the market and some services are provided at zero marginal cost to the consumer. If a public service charges for its services, the charge is not intended to be proportionate to the benefit.
- Prices (fees) often do not allow recovery of fixed costs and may not cover variable costs.
- Total cost to the consumer may be constant per unit of time and independent of the quantity consumed.
- Public services are redistributive, in the sense that those who pay are not necessarily those who receive.
- Another characteristic nature of public services is that such services are operated as a trust. Universities and public libraries fall into this category. It stems from their character as a form of collective provision. It is in the nature of collective provision that the individuals who pay for services, who make administrative decisions, who receive services or who are affected by collective measures are not necessarily the same people (Spicker, 2009).

Public service delivery systems may be capital intensive as in the cases of sewer and water systems, and transportation systems; or labour intensive as in education, medical care, police protection, etc. or intermediate between these extremes. In some cases, both public and private service providers may be involved. Consumers utilize these services directly and indirectly through consumption of private sector goods and services containing a community services input component.

Owing to the fact that public services vary from highly labour intensive to highly capital intensive, the appropriate delivery system depends upon the service being

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delivered and may vary among communities. Preferences and socio-economic characteristics of the client population in interaction with the total environment determine locational differences in consumer expectations and desires. A delivery system that is outstanding in one community may be totally inadequate if transplanted to another location (Jones and Gessaman, 1974).

3. The issue of public service delivery

What municipal government does, who does it and with what resources vary from country to country, and from town to town. Countries following the British tradition of local government tend to look at municipalities as service delivery agencies, and to specify functions and finances, boundaries, and central control in relation to this role. The role of local government in South Africa is largely the delivery of basic services to the communities, and one of its challenges today is to provide effective and efficient service delivery. Generally, however, municipal public services in most countries comprise:

- garbage collection/waste management;
- water supply/sewerage;
- environmental services, streetlight maintenance, parks and recreation;
- primary health care and education (in some countries only, usually to complement central government services);
- some social welfare (e.g. shelters for the homeless);
- internal transport;
- urban planning and regulatory enforcement;
- local public works and housing;
- fire fighting and other emergency services; and
- traffic regulation.

Over the years, many municipalities in South Africa have been soundly criticized for poor services. Owing to the importance of local services that they provide, they are subjected to a daily barrage of questions and complaints directly in the press, civic organizations, community based organizations, etc.

3.1 Service delivery theory

Despite decades of foreign aid, service delivery in Africa continues to fail those who need them the most, namely the poor. What is more in African countries' poor performance in service delivery is that it seems unresponsive to changes in institutional arrangements, as failure continues to thrive under both centralized and decentralized delivery mechanisms. For many, this picture invites pessimism; as such sustained deprivation has caused ill-health and illiteracy to persist throughout time in parts of Africa. For others, this calls for immediate action by African governments, implying that poor service delivery has special political salience in Africa. Indeed, there is consensus in the international community that Africa's shortcomings in service delivery must be treated as an emergency if the continent is to meet the Millennium development goals.

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3.2 The theory of public service delivery

The term public services are typically applied to:

- activities of government in the public domain, such as policing and public health;
- activities done for the benefit of the public, like public service broadcasting or rubbish collection; and
- "social services," like medical care, housing, education, and social care.

Services like energy supply, medical care, or transport can be public services (though they can also be commercial activities). Some public services deliver things that might, in other circumstances, be considered to be part of industrial production – communications, roads, water, or post offices.

"Public services are the responsibility of public authorities" (European Commission, 2005, p. 25). They are not about provision by the state, or provision on behalf of the state, but provision for the public, whether or not it is done by public authorities. They may be linked to government activities, but they are not confined to government, and government does not cover the full range of such activities (Spicker, 2009).

Public services are intended, not to meet the objectives or preferences of consumers or producers, but to further objectives that policy-makers consider desirable – whoever those policy makers may be, because the term might include not just government, but governing bodies, voluntary organizations, mutualist societies, philanthropists, and others.

Economists view the delivery of public services as a resource-using activities aimed at enhancing public welfare. The quality and availability of essential services, such as health care and primary education, are a key measure of governance. Public services underpin the social contract between states and citizens and, as such, are an indicator of the health of a society. Services comprise a core element of the social contract. Public access to good services indicates that a society is well-governed and enables the political leadership to draw continued support for its programme. Throughout Africa, governments have been entrusted to finance and provide basic services such as health, education, telecommunications, safe water, and modern sanitation. Adequate access to these services enhances development. Thus, improving public service delivery is one of the biggest challenges worldwide. Public services are a key determinant of quality of life that is not measured in per capita income. They are also an important element of any poverty reduction strategy.

A major part of populations in Africa (especially in the rural areas) live without access to basic services such as clean water and sanitation, basic healthcare services, proper primary education, and agricultural extension services. The reasons for dysfunctional service delivery are many and complex, but most often, they relate to lack of accountability, transparency, and commitment in making services work for poor and marginalized citizens. In many cases, the lack of implementation and absorptive capacity of government agencies and citizens, respectively, are problems that hamper efficient service delivery. Inadequate targeting of the poor, supply-driven planning, elite capturing of programmes, lack of voice of the poor and their inability to reach the government and service providers, are among the most common reasons. Often, government services fail to reach the poor in rural and remote areas, and when services are provided, they rarely reduce poverty.

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Fox and Meyers define service delivery as the provision of public activities, benefits or satisfactions to the citizens. Service delivery relates both to the provision of tangible public goods and intangible services. This can be done by government institutions, organizations, private companies, non profit organizations and individual service providers. Before any service could or should be delivered, it is necessary to find out whether policies have the desired impact and how citizens respond to them. The main tradition in the analysis of public service provision has been to study how people respond to policies and to gauge who the beneficiaries are from various public programmes. In the area of public service delivery, there is a broad consensus regarding the main policy objectives – to have a well educated and healthy population. Again, the question is what is the best way of delivering to this end? Consider the case of primary education. There are debates about the best way to incentivise teachers, whether to prioritise availability of textbooks, etc. For this to be debated, it is necessary to have some persuasive evidence on the costs and benefits of particular intervention strategies.

4. Service satisfaction

Consumer expectations are at the centre of studies of satisfaction. Although there is general agreement about the influence of customer's expectations in overall service quality and customer satisfaction, considerable work remains to be done regarding the exact way this process takes place (Coye, 2004). It is assumed that consumers create expectations prior to their service experience against which performance is evaluated. Perception can disconfirm expectation (either for "worse" or "better") or confirm it ("neutral" comparison).

Demand for the best service is perhaps the major claim among users of a given public service. Authors believe that satisfaction is an emotional reaction, a transaction-specific measure (Bitner, 1990; Bolton and Drew, 1991; Cronin and Taylor, 1992). Emotions refer to a set of responses occurring especially during consumer experience (Westbrook and Oliver, 1991). High levels of satisfaction may include positive and negative emotions (Arnould and Price, 1993). Putnam (2000) and Orren (1997) also argue that public satisfaction with public trust in government is a function of both public expectation and perception of governmental performance. He identifies an inverse relationship between public satisfaction and public expectation but a positive relationship between public satisfaction and public perception of governmental performance. These authors opine that different factors involved in the perception and expectation dimensions jointly affect the level of public satisfaction with governmental performance. Satisfaction is perceived as a global consumer response in which consumers reflect on their pleasure level. Satisfaction is based on service delivery predictions/norms that depend on past experiences, driven by conceptual cues (e.g. equity, regret) (Oliver, 1997).

4.1 Citizens survey

Howard (2010) suggests that the rise of citizen surveys reflects several mega-trends in governance and administration, including neoliberalism and new public management. Their appeal is due to the following reasons: The current emphasis on ensuring that public services reflect the needs and preferences of citizens, rather than the internal priorities of administrative systems. There is also the broader sense that citizens have grown increasingly unhappy with the performance of governments, leading to diminished engagement and trust (Bouckaert and van de Walle, 2003). Another reason

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is the increasing stress placed upon "evidence" within policy formulation and public management (Nutley *et al.*, 2007).

5. Research methodology

The sampling procedure was carefully designed, taking into account the spatial distribution of the population in the Sedibeng District Municipality and the three LMs. A structured sample of 1,000 respondents was used for the study.

Statistics are a part of the process that involves tabulation of information or data in order to clearly, specifically and effectively describe the data collected. The first of the two branches of statistics used in this study was descriptive statistics. The second was inferential statistics, which establishes the level of confidence with which the researcher can generalise from the sample to the entire population. The strategy that was used in this investigation was twofold and employed descriptive and inferential statistics.

5.1 Results of the study

In this section, the results obtained from the empirical analyses are reviewed, beginning with a descriptive analysis.

5.1.1 Descriptive statistics.

5.1.1.1 Socio-demographic variables. Previous research revealed that socio-demographic characteristics influence the level of satisfaction with specific public services (Kampen *et al.*, 2003). Three socio-demographic factors – age, gender and length of residence in the community – were included as control variables. Length of residence was measured in years.

5.1.1.2 Age distribution of respondents. In the three LMs, most of the respondents fall within the 25-39 and 40-65 age brackets. More than 70 percent of respondents in the municipalities fall within these age brackets. The youth account for between 10 percent in Midvaal and 19.8 percent in Emfuleni of the respondents interviewed. The elderly included in the sample ranged from about 6 percent in Emfuleni to 15.5 percent in Midvaal (Figure 1).

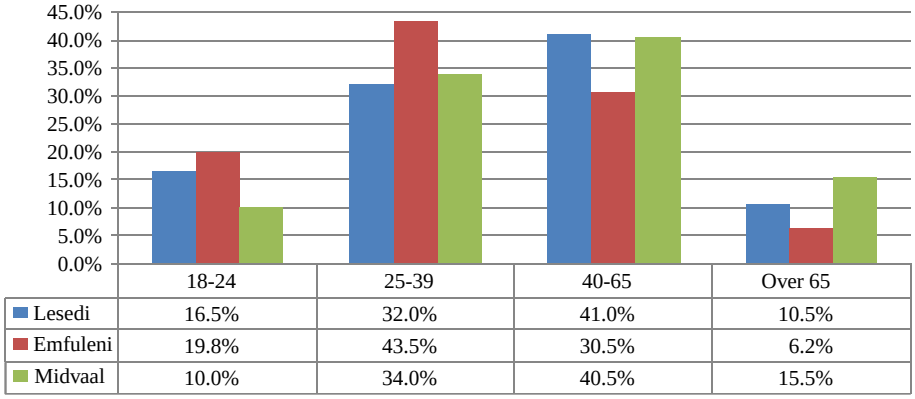
5.1.1.3 Gender of respondents. Overall, slightly more than 50 percent of respondents were male while slightly below 50 percent were female (Figure 2).

5.1.1.4 Community of residence. Community of residence was also included as a control variable to examine whether differences existed between the three LMs, with respect to levels of community satisfaction with public service delivery and participation in service delivery protests. The measure was coded to indicate in which LM the respondent lived (1 = Lesedi; 2 = Emfuleni; 3 = Midvaal) (Table II).

On average respondents interviewed in Emfuleni have lived longer in the LM compared with the other two LMs. Whereas respondents have lived on average 26 years in Emfuleni, they have lived for 14 years in Midvaal and about 13 years in Lesedi.

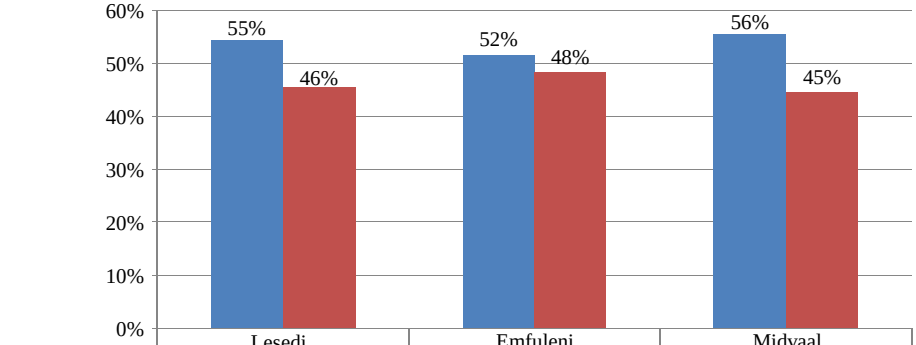
6. Satisfaction with service delivery

Customer satisfaction is the overall level of attainment of a customer's expectations. It could be measured as the percentage of customer expectations which has actually been fulfilled. In this study, respondent's satisfaction was assessed with both a multi-item domain-specific satisfaction scale and a single measure of general satisfaction.



	18-24	25-39	40-65	Over 65
Lesedi	16.5%	32.0%	41.0%	10.5%
Emfuleni	19.8%	43.5%	30.5%	6.2%
Midvaal	10.0%	34.0%	40.5%	15.5%

Figure 1.
Age distribution of respondents



	Lesedi	Emfuleni	Midvaal
% of Males	55%	52%	56%
% of Females	46%	48%	45%

Figure 2.
Gender of respondents

Local municipality	Years
Lesedi	12.9
Emfuleni	26.0
Midvaal	14.0
Grand total	21.0

Table II.
No. of years residing in the LM

Respondents were asked to rate their satisfaction with the following nine items:

(1) health care services;
(2) housing;
(3) water services;
(4) electricity;
(5) solid waste removal;
(6) community services or overall physical appearance of the community;

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(7) Roads;
(8) cutting crime; and
(9) job creation.

Are Sedibeng citizens satisfied with the delivery of public services? The proportion of respondents who are satisfied with public service delivery is generally low and this is consistent with previous research findings on satisfaction with public service delivery in South Africa.

In general terms, respondents from Emfuleni LM hold more positive feelings about public service delivery in the area of water, electricity, and solid waste. Their most negative feeling is in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

In balance, respondents from Lesedi hold positive feelings about public service delivery only in the area of water and electricity supplies. Similarly, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

Respondents from Midvaal do not hold positive feelings about public service delivery in their LM. Similar to other two LMs, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

Overall, the most negative sentiment about public service delivery has been expressed by respondents from Midvaal, followed by Emfuleni and Lesedi.

The low mean satisfaction scores for roads, job creation, and crime reflect the real challenges facing the Government of South Africa. Crime rates are high as is unemployment. The ratings for roads also show that overall service satisfaction for roads is likely reflect the perennial problems of pot holes and serious traffic accidents which have claimed many lives.

The ranking of satisfaction with public service delivery by respondents ranged from 1 (completely dissatisfied) to 7 (completely satisfied). According to Cooper (2000), this type of scale is considered to be an interval scale. Therefore, measurement of central tendency and its dispersion can be made.

A composite domain-specific satisfaction score was calculated by averaging the responses for the items. High scores reflected high levels of domain satisfaction; low scores indicated low levels. In a general measure, respondents were asked to indicate how satisfied, overall, they were with life in their community. Responses were dichotomized as 0 (very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, neither satisfied nor dissatisfied, and somewhat satisfied) and 1 (very satisfied).

The average level of satisfaction, overall, is 2.06, which is quite low. This falls within the category of citizens being very dissatisfied with public service delivery in general. Access to sanitation has been described as access to various forms including flush toilets, dry toilets, chemical toilets, and pit latrines but excludes the bucket system and people with no access to sanitation. The Statistics SA Community Survey of 2007 indicates that Sedibeng has a high sanitation service level, with 98.5 percent of the households having access to sanitation. Emfuleni has the highest sanitation service levels in the district at 99.2 percent, followed by Midvaal at 98.3 percent and Lesedi at 91.8 percent. It is for this reason that access to water has a higher rating than other public services.

Formal housing has increased in the past two years within the Sedibeng District by 5.9 percent which led to partial formalization of at least four informal settlements.

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The challenge has been the growing of existing informal settlements after the beneficiary administration has already been completed. Informal residential settlements can be defined as settlements that do not have any formal town-planning structure and have limited access to basic engineering services such as water, sewerage, and electricity. There are 35 informal settlements in Sedibeng with six being in the process of being formalized.

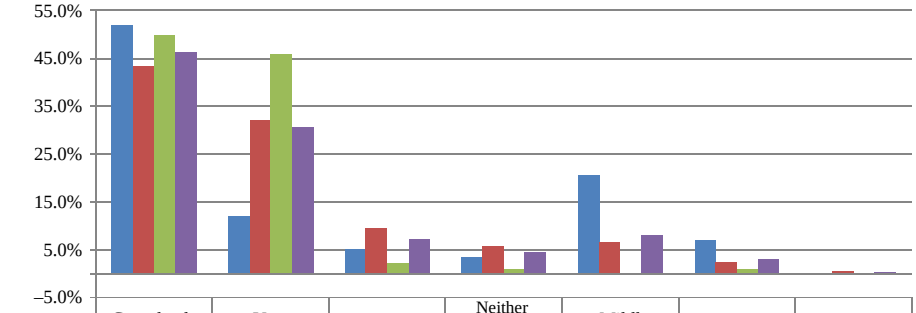
Midvaal has the highest percentage of formal housing at 86.3 percent followed by Emfuleni and Lesedi at 82.9 and 82.1 percent, respectively. Emfuleni has the highest percentage of informal housing at 14.9 percent followed by Lesedi at 13.8 percent and Midvaal at 8.4 percent. There has been a dramatic improvement in the process of formalizing informal housing in Sedibeng between 2001 and 2007 with Midvaal showing the greatest achievement of 8.3 percent followed by Lesedi at 6.4 percent. Emfuleni made the least improvement at 1.6 percent.

6.1 Satisfaction with all the services provided by the municipality

The percentage shown in Figure 3 shows that most of the respondents are not satisfied with the services delivered by the municipality in the region. This result is consistent with the mean satisfaction score we obtained (which is 2.06). However, from Tables III and IV, one can note that satisfaction may vary among local districts. It can be noted that Lesedi is the district which shows the lowest percentage of dissatisfaction with the service delivery, while Midvaal presents the highest percentage of dissatisfaction.

The proportion of respondents that are either very dissatisfied or completely dissatisfied is highest in Midvaal (96 percent) followed by Emfuleni (75.2 percent) and Lesedi (64 percent). The proportion of respondents that are mildly satisfied, very satisfied or completely satisfied is highest in Lesedi (27.5 percent) followed by Emfuleni (9.3 percent) and Midvaal (1.0 percent).

Most of the respondents do not feel that the Municipality provides a flexible service to meet their individual needs. About 88 percent of respondents in Midvaal, 60 percent of respondents in Lesedi and 53 percent of respondents in Emfuleni are of the opinion that the Municipality does not provide flexible services to meet their



	Completely dissatisfied	Very dissatisfied	Mildly Dissatisfied	Neither Dissatisfied nor satisfied	Mildly Satisfied	Very Satisfied	Completely Satisfied
Lesedi	52.0%	12.0%	5.0%	3.5%	20.5%	7.0%	0.0%
Emfuleni	43.3%	32.0%	9.5%	5.8%	6.5%	2.3%	0.5%
Midvaal	50.0%	46.0%	2.0%	1.0%	0.0%	1.0%	0.0%
Total	46.4%	30.8%	7.1%	4.4%	8.0%	3.0%	0.3%

Figure 3.
Satisfaction with overall services provided by Sedibeng District Municipality

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Table III.
Summary rating of public service delivery in Sedibeng District Municipality

Public service category	Lesedi			Emfuleni			Midvaal		
	Extremely, very or fairly poor	Unsure	Extremely, very or fairly good	Extremely, very or fairly poor	Unsure	Extremely, very or fairly good	Extremely, very or fairly poor	Unsure	Extremely, very or fairly good
Health	52	16	33	54	9	38	54	37	11
Housing	54	6	42	73	5	22	68	27	7
Water	33	12	56	14	3	81	48	34	20
Electricity	46	9	46	16	6	79	56	32	14
Solid waste	51	28	23	29	15	56	78	8	15
Community service	67	31	4	72	12	17	83	11	6
Roads	79	12	10	89	5	6	98	1	1
Cutting crime	98	1	1	82	10	9	98	1	2
Creating jobs	98	2	0	91	2	7	98	1	1
Overall satisfaction	67	4	28	85	6	9	98	1	1

Table IV.
Rating of satisfaction with public service delivery in Sedibeng Municipality

District	Health	Housing	Water	Electricity	Solid waste removal	Community service	Roads	Cutting crime	Creating jobs
Lesedi	3.37	3.36	4.24	3.40	2.92	2.35	1.88	1.13	1.12
Emfuleni	3.57	2.79	5.26	5.11	4.32	2.60	1.95	2.06	1.55
Midvaal	3.15	2.51	3.52	2.73	2.045	1.67	1.105	1.225	1.135
All	3.44	2.85	4.71	4.29	3.58	2.36	1.76	1.70	1.38

individual needs. The highest proportion (28 percent) of respondents that opine in favour of the municipality is from Lesedi, while the lowest (5 percent) is from Midvaal.

6.2 Concluding remarks

This study has examined satisfaction with service delivery in the Sedibeng District Municipality.

Are Sedibeng citizens satisfied with the delivery of public services? In general terms, respondents from Emfuleni LM hold more positive feelings about public service delivery in the area of water, electricity and solid waste. Their most negative feeling is in the area of job creation, roads and the Municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

In balance, respondents from Lesedi hold positive feelings about public service delivery only in the area of water and electricity supplies. Similarly, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

Respondents from Midvaal do not hold positive feelings about public service delivery in their LM. Similar to the other two LMs, their most negative feelings are in the area of job creation, roads, and the municipality's efforts in cutting crime.

Overall, the most negative sentiment about public service delivery has been expressed by respondents from Midvaal, followed by Emfuleni and Lesedi. The low mean

satisfaction scores for roads, job creation and crime reflect the real challenges facing the Government of South Africa. Crime rates are high as is unemployment. The ratings for roads also show that overall service satisfaction for roads is likely to reflect the perennial problems of pot holes and serious traffic accidents which have claimed many lives.

The proportion of respondents who are satisfied with public service delivery is generally low and this is consistent with previous research findings on satisfaction with public service delivery in South Africa. Younger people are more likely to express these negative strong feelings against the municipality. Age is positively and strongly correlated with the expression of feelings that there is corruption in the municipality. This means that older people feel more, that there is corruption in the municipality.

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